READBACK

AI ATC FOR DCS

User Manual

How Readback ATC works, how to run it on your DCS World server, and exactly what your pilots say to each controller - with the answers they will hear.

Contents

1. How Readback ATC works
2. Before the first flight
3. The controllers
4. Radio technique
5. Tower
6. ATIS, weather and runways
7. Command
8. AWACS (GCI)
9. Carrier: Deckboss, Marshal and Paddles
10. Tankers and JTAC
11. The dashboard
12. Logs, Fleet and Pilots
13. Settings
14. Voices and running costs
15. Reports: After Action Reports
16. Stats: flight stats and the greenie board
17. A frequency card for your pilots
18. When something is wrong
19. Glossary

1. How Readback ATC works

Readback ATC runs on the PC that hosts your **SRS server**, next to DCS. Each controller is a separate program that joins SRS like a radio and listens on its own frequency.

1. **A pilot transmits** on SRS. The controller on that frequency records the call.
2. **Speech to text**: the recording goes to OpenAI's speech recognition, which returns the words.
3. **The controller decides** what was asked - taxi, check in, picture, ball - using the mission's weather and runways and, where it needs positions, the live air picture from **Tacview**.
4. **Text to speech**: the answer is spoken with the voice you chose (Windows, OpenAI or ElevenLabs), given a radio sound, and transmitted back on the same frequency through SRS.

It reads	For
SRS (with External AWACS Mode on)	Hearing pilots and talking back. Required.
OpenAI API key	Speech recognition. Required, whichever voices you use.

Tacview real-time telemetry	Positions: the AWACS picture, radar checks, Command's handoffs and bearings, Marshal's radar contact, Paddles' groove calls, traffic alerts and the dashboard's air picture. Strongly recommended; towers still work without it.
The **mission file** (.miz) DCS is running	Weather, wind and altimeter for ATIS and the towers, and which runways are in use. Followed automatically when the server loads a new mission.
The **DCS server's dcs.log**	Reports and Stats: shots, kills, takeoffs, landings and carrier grades.

> Readback ATC never changes your mission or DCS itself. It is a voice on the radio: DCS still runs the AI tankers, carriers and airfields.

2. Before the first flight

1. **Finish Setup** (it opens after install): squadron, keys, SRS server and password, theatre, then the **test call**. A test call you hear in SRS proves the whole voice path.
2. On the dashboard pick your **theatre** and press **Start**. Each controller turns green as it joins SRS.
3. In SRS, tune a tower frequency and call: *"Batumi Tower, Viper 1-1, radio check."* You should hear *"Viper 1-1, Batumi Tower, loud and clear."*
4. Give your pilots the frequencies (section 17) and this manual's call tables, or the shorter tables in section 4 onward.
5. Leave the dashboard running during your event. The **Live Transmission Log** shows every call as it happens.

3. The controllers

The standard start files (made by Setup) run the towers, ATIS, Command, the AWACS, Marshal and Deckboss. Paddles, the tankers and the JTACs are in the start files of squadrons that use them; the **Roles** table in Settings lists what yours run.

Station	Default frequency	What it does
Tower (one per field)	The field's DCS tower frequency	Radio checks, startup, taxi, takeoff, departure handoff, arrivals and the overhead break, straight-ins, go-arounds, emergencies, traffic alerts.
ATIS	The field's ATIS frequency	A looping weather and runway broadcast with an information letter.
Command	282.000 AM	The strike net: check-in, fence in/out, tasking, tanker requests, combat calls, fuel, and the recovery handoff.
AWACS (e.g. Darkstar)	264.000 AM, or as set in Setup	Picture, bogey dope, declare, snaplock, spiked, vectors, and threat calls on its own.
Deckboss	128.600 AM	Carrier launches: catapults, tension, airborne, push to Marshal.
Marshal	306.300 AM	Carrier recovery: check-in, the stack, Charlie, Case I and Case III.

Paddles	128.300 AM	The LSO: ball call, live glideslope and lineup calls, wave-offs, grades.
Tankers (Texaco, Shell)	As your start files set	Join-up, fuel request, observation, basket or boom, reform and departure.
JTAC (e.g. Hitman)	As your start files set (FM)	Close air support: target brief, readback, cleared hot, BDA.

Every frequency, name and voice can be changed in **Settings > Roles** (section 13).

4. Radio technique

Readback ATC listens like a real controller: it answers calls addressed to it, from a callsign it can hear.

- **Address first, then your callsign, then the request**: *"Batumi Tower, Viper 1-1, request taxi."*
- **Use a callsign with a number** - *Viper 1-1*, *Venom 2-1-2* or a modex such as *Raider 302* - and keep it the same all flight. A call without a number is not answered.
- **Key, pause half a second, then speak.** Release and wait 2-3 seconds for the answer; don't key over it.
- **Keep it under 20 seconds.** Two short calls beat one long one.
- **Numbers**: say them naturally - *"state 6.5"*, *"angels 12"*, *"seven DME"*, *"runway 13"*.
- **Flights**: the lead talks for the flight - *"Batumi Tower, Viper 1-1, flight of two, ready for takeoff."* One clearance covers everyone.
- **Didn't catch it?** *"Batumi Tower, Viper 1-1, say again."* repeats the last answer to you.
- Common mishearings are corrected for you (for example *Reader* or *Rater* becomes *Raider*), and a field name a letter or two off still counts.

The call tables below are the wordings Readback is tested against; similar wordings work too. The examples use Batumi and Viper 1-1 - use your field and callsign.

5. Tower

Address the tower in any of these ways: *"Batumi Tower, ..."*, *"Batumi, ..."*, *"Tower, ..."*, or CTAF style *"Batumi Traffic, Viper 1-1, rolling runway 13."*

Ground and departure

When	Say	You hear
Radio check	radio check / comm check / how copy / green jet	Loud and clear.
Before engines	request startup	Startup approved.
Taxi	request taxi / ready to taxi	Altimeter, taxi to the runway, hold short.

At the hold	holding short / at the hold	Line up and wait - then cleared for takeoff when the runway is clear.
Takeoff	ready for takeoff / request takeoff	Wind, runway, cleared for takeoff, report airborne.
After takeoff	airborne / departing / rolling runway 13	Climb to angels N, expect handoff at seven DME.
Leaving	seven DME / request handoff / pushing command	Handoff to Command, or good day.

At about **7 nm** the tower's departure controller calls you on its own: *"Viper 1-1, Batumi Departure, have you seven miles, angels six, you are leaving my airspace. Push Command, two eight two point zero. Good day."* This needs Tacview; without it, call *"seven DME"* yourself.

```
Pilot: Batumi Tower, Viper 1-1, request taxi.
Tower: Viper 1-1, Batumi Tower, roger, altimeter two niner niner two, taxi runway one three, hold short of the runway, advise when ready for takeoff.
Pilot: Batumi Tower, Viper 1-1, holding short runway 13.
Tower: Viper 1-1, Batumi Tower, line up and wait runway one three.
Tower: Viper 1-1, Batumi Tower, wind one two zero at four, runway one three, cleared for takeoff. Report airborne.
Pilot: Batumi Tower, Viper 1-1, airborne.
Tower: Viper 1-1, Batumi Tower, proceed to angels five, expect handoff at seven DME.
```

Arrival and the pattern

When	Say	You hear
Inbound	10 mile initial / 10 miles inbound	Runway, wind, altimeter, report initial.
Overhead	3 mile initial / overhead	Break approved, number N, report base.
Break	break	Report downwind.
Downwind	downwind	Number N, report base.
Base	base, gear down	Cleared to land.
Final	on final / 5 mile final	Cleared to land, runway NN.
Touch and go	on final, touch and go	Cleared touch and go.
Straight in	request straight in / ILS approach	Straight-in approved, report final.
Go-around	going around	Climb runway heading, report downwind.
Off the runway	runway vacated / clear of the active	Taxi to parking.

Flights

When	Say	You hear
At the hold	flight of two, Viper 1-2, holding short	Viper 1-1 flight, line up and wait.
Takeoff	flight of two, ready for takeoff / two-ship, ready for takeoff	One takeoff clearance for the flight.

Inbound	flight of two, 10 miles inbound full stop	Viper 1-1 flight, runway, wind, report initial.
Landing	flight of two, full stop	Cleared to land - the whole flight.
Vacated	flight of two, clear of the active	Taxi to parking for every jet.

Any time

When	Say	You hear
Repeat	say again	Your last answer again (within 2 minutes).
Wind and altimeter	wind check / say altimeter	Wind and altimeter.
Where am I	radar check	Angels, range and bearing from the field (Tacview).
Hung ordnance	hung ordnance	Straight in, de-arm at the end of the runway.
Emergency	mayday mayday mayday / pan pan / declaring emergency, request runway 13	The runway is yours - the one you name, if you name one. You go to the top of the queue.
After an emergency	one soul on board, fuel state 1.5	Crash crew standing by, cleared to land.

Traffic alerts: with Tacview, the tower warns two airborne aircraft near the field that are converging to a close pass - *"traffic alert, two o'clock, one mile, same altitude"*. Formations and rejoins stay quiet.

Red fields: each tower card on the dashboard has a **Blue/Red** switch. A red field's tower talks to the red coalition on SRS and hands its departures to Red Command, for servers that run one.

6. ATIS, weather and runways

- **Weather comes from the mission** DCS is running: wind, ceiling, visibility, altimeter and temperature. When the server loads a different mission, every controller reloads its weather.
- **The runway in use** is chosen from the wind, like a real tower. Every controller at a field agrees on it, and the ATIS says the same.
- **ATIS** loops on its frequency. Its information letter moves on (Alpha, Bravo ...) only when the weather or runway changes, so hearing *Alpha* for hours is normal.
- **Set Weather** on the dashboard sets the wind, ceiling, visibility and altimeter for the towers, Marshal and Deckboss straight away; **Read from .miz** fills in the mission's values again.
- **Carrier case**: Marshal picks Case I or Case III from the ceiling, visibility and night. The dashboard's case selector can force Case I or Case III; **Auto** goes back to the weather.

7. Command

Command is the mission's controller between the airfield and the fight. Address it as *"Command, Viper 1-1, ..."*.

When	Say	You hear
Radio check	radio check / how copy	Loud and clear.
Check in	checking in	Loud and clear, proceed mission.
Fence in	fence in, state 6.2	Copy fence in, cleared hot.
On / off station	on station / off station	Copy on station, good hunting. / Proceed to assigned pattern.
Ask for work	request tasking	Your tasking, or the JTAC to contact, where your mission has them.
Tanker	request tanker	The nearest tanker's bearing, range and angels, and its frequency.
Bullseye	say bullseye	Your position from bullseye (Tacview).
Weapons	in hot / pickle / rifle	Cleared hot. / Copy pickle. / Copy rifle.
Shots and kills	Fox 3 / splash one MiG-29	Copy Fox three. / Copy splash, good kill.
Fuel	state 5.2 / Joker / Bingo, RTB	Copy state. / Copy Joker. / Copy Bingo, RTB, nearest tanker.
Out of weapons	Winchester, RTB	Copy Winchester, RTB, handoff at 30 nm.
Going home	fence out / RTB / request recovery	Copy fence out, safe passage. / Expect handoff at 30 nm.

Coming home, Command hands you to the tower - or to Marshal for the carrier - at about **30 nm** (Tacview). A call of *"Viper 1-2 down"* gets *"Viper 1-2 down, launching CSAR."*

8. AWACS (GCI)

The AWACS uses its callsign (Darkstar in these examples; you set it in Setup) and sees what Tacview sees - only what the AWACS aircraft could see over the terrain, if your mission has one airborne.

When	Say	You hear
Radio check	radio check / comm check	Good copy - or "... but I don't see you on scope".
Check in	checking in	Radar contact.
Fence in	fence in	Copy fence in, then a picture.
Where am I	alpha check	Your position from bullseye.
The air picture	picture / request picture	Up to three groups: bullseye, altitude, track, ID, contacts, type.
Nearest threat	bogey dope	Group BRAA 045/32, 25,000, hot, hostile, Flanker.
Jets or helicopters only	any fast movers / any slow movers	The nearest fixed-wing or helicopter group.
Identify a contact	declare bullseye 010 for 48 at 25000	Hostile, friendly, furball or clean.

Contact on your nose	snaplock 125 for 10 at 8000	The group there, as BRAA.
RWR spike	spiked 080 / strobe 080	The group on that bearing - or clean.
Steer	vector to tanker	Bearing and range to the nearest tanker.
Kill	splash one	Copy splash one.
Leaving	fence out / checking out	Copy fence out. / Copy, good day.

Without being asked, the AWACS broadcasts a **picture every few minutes** and calls **threats**, **merges** and **faded** contacts to the flights it is controlling. With no AWACS aircraft airborne it reports off station.

9. Carrier: Deckboss, Marshal and Paddles

Deckboss - launch

Lead with *"Deckboss"*. Four catapults; when all are busy you join the queue.

When	Say	You hear
Ready to go	request taxi / green jet	Cleared to cat N, or wait in line.
On the cat	ready cat 2 / shoot	Under tension, spin it up, shooter's discretion.
After the shot	airborne	Push Marshal, three zero six point three.
Carrier heading	say BRC	Mother's BRC (magnetic).

Marshal - recovery

Lead with *"Marshal"* (or *"Union Marshal"*) and give your callsign with its number.

When	Say	You hear
Check in	checking in	Range and bearing; say marking moms.
Marking moms	marking moms 340 for 30, angels 12, state 6.5	Radar contact, weather, case, BRC, altimeter, your stack angels, report see me at ten.
Ten miles	see you at ten	Visual at ten, say state.
Fuel	state 5.2	Copy state.
In the stack	established angels 2	Signal Charlie - or hold, with your position.
Leaving the stack	commencing	Copy commencing, check in three mile initial.
Case III	request push time	Expected approach time MM; a new one if yours has passed. Times are a minute apart.
Case III	platform	Final bearing NNN. At three miles Marshal hands you to Paddles: "contact paddles, call the ball".
Case III	needles up and left / negative needles / coupled / command control	Roger (negative needles: fly bullseye). After commencing these may start with your modex alone.

Three miles	initial / three mile initial	Paddles has you, good luck.
Departing	clear seven miles	Push Command.

```
Pilot: Marshal, Viper 1-1, marking moms 340 for 30, angels 12, state 6.5.
Marshal: Viper 1-1, Union Marshal, radar contact, angels 12, range 30 miles, bearing three four zero from mother, expect Case One recovery, BRC 275, altimeter two niner niner two, Marshal at angels two, report see me at ten.
Pilot: Union Marshal, Viper 1-1, see you at ten.
Marshal: Viper 1-1, Union Marshal, visual on mother at ten, say state.
Pilot: Union Marshal, Viper 1-1, established angels two, state 5.8.
Marshal: Viper 1-1, Union Marshal, signal Charlie.
Pilot: Union Marshal, Viper 1-1, commencing.
Marshal: Viper 1-1, Union Marshal, copy commencing, check in three mile initial.
Pilot: Union Marshal, Viper 1-1, three mile initial.
Marshal: Viper 1-1, Union Marshal, Paddles has you, good luck.
```

> **Case III** (night, or a low ceiling or poor visibility): marking moms gets a holding radial and a push time - hold on the radial at the DME and angels Marshal gives (the stack starts at angels 6, at angels + 15 DME: angels 6 holds at 21 DME) and commence at that minute. Commencing: descend to platform (5,000 ft) on the final bearing; call *"platform"* passing 5,000 ft. All bearings are magnetic.

Paddles - the LSO

Paddles watches your approach in Tacview and talks you down: you fly, Paddles calls. Give your modex or full callsign.

When	Say	You hear
In the break	in the break	Roger, call abeam.
Abeam	abeam	Paddles contact, Hornet in the groove, at three-quarters of a mile call the ball.
Ball	Hornet ball, 5.5	Roger ball.
No ball	Clara, 5.0	Paddles contact, keep it coming.
After the trap	red deck	(No reply. The deck is foul: the next jet is waved off.)
Clear of the landing area	green deck	Roger green deck, contact Deckboss.

In the groove Paddles calls what it sees, up to once a second while you are off: *a little high*, *you're high*, *you're low*, *power*, *right for lineup*, *come left*, *you're fast / slow*. No ball call by about 0.6 nm brings *"call the ball"*. **"Wave off, wave off, wave off"** is mandatory: power and climb straight ahead. Paddles grades every pass (_OK_, OK, (OK), ---, cut, bolter, wave-off) with the wire in its log; DCS's own LSO grade for each trap goes to the greenie board on the Stats page.

A full carrier cycle

Deckboss (launch) → Marshal (on departure: *clear seven miles*) → Command for the mission → Command hands you back to Marshal at about 30 nm → Marshal (stack, Charlie, commencing, initial) → Paddles (break, abeam, ball, trap) → green deck → Deckboss.

10. Tankers and JTAC

Where your start files run them. Readback is the voice on the tanker's frequency; DCS still flies the tanker, and the DCS comms menu's **Ready pre-contact** is still needed before fuel flows.

Tanker (Texaco, Shell)

Step	Say	You hear
Initial	Texaco 1-1, Viper 1-1, 15 mile initial for port observation, intent to refuel	Cleared port observation, angels, velocity. How much do you request?
Give	request 5.0 / request full	You are cleared for five thousand pounds / full give.
Trail	1 mile trail for port observation	Continue port observation.
Observation	established port observation	Copy. Port and starboard baskets open.
Basket	moving to port basket	Cleared port basket - or standby, basket occupied.
At the basket	established port basket	Copy, call ready pre-contact.
Ready	ready pre-contact	Cleared contact, port basket.
Done	satisfied, moving to starboard reform	Cleared starboard reform.
Leaving	checking out / moving on to mission	Cleared to depart.

Observation is always port, reform always starboard. One jet per basket; a boom tanker (Shell) takes one receiver at a time (*"moving to the boom"*). The lead makes the initial and checking-out calls for the flight.

JTAC (Hitman)

Step	Say	You hear
Check in	checking in / request tasking	Target, name and IP; read back.
Readback	target 4, Indigo	Good readback, report IP inbound.
IP	IP inbound	Continue.
Attack	in from the south / in heading 330	Cleared hot - or abort, abort, abort.
Off	off / off safe	Egress.
Results	request BDA	The effects, then re-attack, a correction, or home.
Abort	abort	Copy abort, re-attack from the IP.

11. The dashboard

Open **Readback ATC** from the Start menu, or **http://localhost:7000** in a browser on the server.

Header

- **First row**: your squadron, this server, the pages (Fleet, Logs, Pilots, Reports, Stats, Settings), the SRS and Tacview status, and the colour button.
- **Second row**: the **theatre switch**, the region buttons that start and stop a theatre, and badges for your licence or trial days and the build.
- **Colours**: the button in the header steps through **Dark**, **Light**, **Night** (red, for a dark room) and **Auto** (follows Windows). Settings > Appearance does the same. Each browser remembers its own choice.
- **Banners** under the header say when the trial is running out, a licence needs renewing, an update is ready, or Setup is not finished.

Panels

Panel	What it shows
Roles	Every controller with its frequency and state, with Start/Stop for each, and **Start all / Stop all** for the towers.
Airborne	Everyone Tacview sees in the air, with bearing and range from bullseye (true), altitude and speed; the aircraft in a field's pattern underneath.
Airfield Traffic	Fields with traffic: who is taxiing, taking off, in the pattern or landing. "All clear" when there is none.
Weather	Ceiling, visibility, altimeter, wind, temperature and night, the carrier case selector and **Set Weather**.
Marshal Stack, Catapults	The carrier's recovery stack and its four catapults (only in a theatre with a carrier).
Live Transmission Log	Every call heard and every answer, as it happens. **Full Log** opens the Logs page.
Comms Report	What the towers flagged, for the debrief: near misses, takeoffs or landings without a clearance, calls with no callsign, callsigns that changed, calls not understood - over the last 3 hours to 7 days.

12. Logs, Fleet and Pilots

- **Logs**: each controller's full log, live, with filters. The first place to look when a call went unanswered: it shows the exact words heard.
- **Fleet**: when you run Readback ATC on more than one server, each one's health, version and air picture on one page.
- **Pilots**: if your server runs DCSServerBot, its pilot statistics (time in slot, kills, landings, traps) by day and by pilot.

13. Settings

Section	What you set
Squadron	Your squadron's name and logo (PNG or JPG), shown on every page and on reports.
Appearance	The colour mode: Dark, Light, Night or Auto.
Updates	Your version, what's new in the latest, and **Update now**.
Licence	Trial days left or your licence, its end date, and the box to paste a licence key.
Voice services	**Windows voices** (free) or **OpenAI voices**, and the OpenAI and ElevenLabs keys, each with a **Test** button. Keys are kept in Windows for your user only; the page shows the last four characters.
Reports	Your own Claude API key, for the written part of After Action Reports (optional).
Server connection	The SRS server address, its External AWACS Mode password, and Tacview's address.
Frequencies	Each field's tower, ATIS and departure-handoff frequency. Changed values are marked; clear a box to go back to the default.
Roles	Every station in three groups, **ATIS**, **Towers** and **Other stations** (Command, Overlord, JTAC, tankers, AWACS, Deckboss, Marshal, Paddles): frequency, name, ElevenLabs voice, OpenAI voice and speed. ▶ plays a sample of a voice. **Remove** takes a station off the air; each group's **Add** list brings a removed one back or starts a new one (below).

Group	Add can start	Notes
ATIS	An ATIS at a field that has none, on a frequency you choose.	A new ATIS reads the weather, runway and altimeter; only the built-in ones also give TACAN and ILS. The built-in ones' frequencies are in the Frequencies table.
Towers	A tower you removed.	The name is what the tower calls itself on the radio, e.g. "Senaki Approach". Pilots still call it by the field's name.

Other stations	A station you removed, or a new one: • **Tanker**: callsign (e.g. Arco-1-1), frequency, altitude, speed, basket or boom, and voice. • **JTAC**: callsign (e.g. Hitman-3-1), frequency, a range sector or the whole range, and voice. • **AWACS**: a second GCI with its own callsign (e.g. Magic), frequency and voices. • **Command**: a second Command with its own SRS name, frequency and voices.	Command speaks for every tanker and JTAC, so they need Command running; an added JTAC also needs Hitman 1-1 on, and Command sends tasked flights to it like the others. A second AWACS or Command runs in its own window, starts and stops with the theatre, and appears on the dashboard; the tankers, JTACs, Overlord and handoffs stay with the theatre's own Command. Removing Command, GCI, Marshal, Deckboss or Paddles stops that controller from starting.

> **Saving a role:** after you change a row, its **Save** button (always at the right of the table) is ringed until you press it. Changes reach a controller when it restarts: press **Restart this theatre's roles** under Roles, or Stop and Start on the dashboard. Moving Command or Marshal also moves the handoffs that point to them. Tell your pilots whenever you move a frequency.

14. Voices and running costs

Service	Used for	Cost
Windows voices	The default voices, built into Windows.	Free.
OpenAI	Speech recognition (always), and OpenAI voices if you choose them.	Billed by OpenAI per use; for a squadron's evening, typically small.
ElevenLabs	The most natural voices, per role (Settings > Roles).	Your ElevenLabs plan's credits. The Stats page shows what your servers used.
Claude (Anthropic)	The written part of After Action Reports, optional.	Billed by Anthropic per report, usually a few cents.

If ElevenLabs fails or runs out, the role answers in its OpenAI voice instead, so pilots always get an answer. Lines a controller says often (Paddles' groove calls, for example) are recorded once and kept, so they cost nothing after.

15. Reports: After Action Reports

The **Reports** page makes an After Action Report of a session: a summary page with the result, a relief map of every kill and the pilot, engagement and missile tables; a page per engagement with the fight's tracks and missiles and every shot (range, launch altitude and speed, kill or miss); the pilots' sorties, flight time and carrier grades; the Safety items (blue-on-blue, ground impacts, ejections); and the AAR itself - BLUF, plan, sustain / improve and recommendations with owners; and, as you choose, a comms score for each pilot, a page per pilot, currency, weapon effectiveness, losses, the carrier recovery and the tankers. Every number and map is worked out on this PC; Claude writes the words, with your own Claude API key (Settings > Reports; create one at console.anthropic.com).

1. Pick the session's records, each found on this PC or uploaded: the **mission file** (.miz: what was planned), the **Tacview recording** (.acmi or .zip.acmi: the tracks) and the **DCS server's dcs.log** (the shots, kills, takeoffs, landings and grades DCS scored). It must be the *server's* log (`Saved Games\DCS.dcs_serverrelease\Logs` on the server); a game client's dcs.log has none of them.
2. Leave **Include the radio logs** ticked to add what was said on Readback's frequencies. The Comms page needs these logs. On a PC that watches several servers, choose which one flew the session, or leave **whichever rig heard the session** to read every server's logs and use the one with the most calls. If none had calls in that window, the preview says where it looked.
3. Optionally say what to focus on, e.g. "Venom flight's carrier recovery".
4. Under **Report contents**, tick the pages you want (the page remembers your choice). A page the session has nothing for is left out and listed at the end under "Not in this report".
5. Press **Preview**: the report's pages appear with everything but Claude's words, and you can read exactly what will be sent.
6. Press **Write the AAR** (or **Save the report** with Claude's write-up unticked: no key needed). Then **Download PDF**, **Print**, or post it: the **Discord post** boxes hold the debrief in your squadron's format, split into messages that fit Discord, each with **Copy**; attach the PDF or the picture of the summary page.

Report contents	What it shows	Needs
Summary page	The result, the map of every kill, the engagement, pilot and weapons tables, Safety.	dcs.log; Tacview for the map
Engagement pages	A page per fight: the tracks, the missiles, every shot.	Tacview and dcs.log
Pilots and greenie board	Every player's sorties, flight time, landings, traps, kills and losses; this session's passes.	dcs.log
Claude's write-up	Key points, BLUF, the AAR sections, sustain / improve, recommendations with owners.	A Claude key
Discord post	The debrief to paste in your squadron's channel.	-

Comms score	Each aircraft out of 100: calls Readback answered (60%), handoffs followed and readbacks given when a controller asked for one (40%), less 5 for each "say again" or comms-report flag; with the change since the last saved report and what cost points. A modex heard two ways ("Raider 302", "reader 302") counts as one aircraft.	Readback's radio logs
A page per pilot	Each player's flight log, carrier passes, weapons, comms score, tanking, losses and currency.	dcs.log
Currency	Each pilot's last sortie and last trap, sorties, landings, traps and tanker plugs in the last 30 (and 90) days: Current within 30 days, Due 31 to 60, Lapsed after that. Counted from every DCS server log on this PC (the ones Stats reads).	The server's logs on this PC
Weapon effectiveness	Each weapon's shots, hits, hit rate and kills, the average launch range of hits and misses, and the ground and sea targets destroyed.	dcs.log; Tacview for ranges
Losses	Every player aircraft lost: shot down (by whom, with what, from how far), crashed or ejected without a kill, whether the pilot ejected or died, and whether Readback called a CSAR launch.	dcs.log
Carrier recovery	Each carrier's recovery: passes, traps, bolters, wave-offs, boarding rate, time between passes, average grade; and each pilot's Marshal check-in, Charlie, commencing, initial, first pass and trap.	dcs.log; radio logs for the Marshal times
Tankers	Each aircraft's tanker, check-in, fuel asked for, first contact, plugs, re-plugs (disconnects) and time in the basket. DCS does not log the fuel passed.	dcs.log; radio logs for the calls

The Marshal and tanker times, and a pilot's comms score on their pilot page, need the radio callsign matched to the DCS player: name your slot with the callsign (`RAIDER 302 | HIKER`) or its modex, and it is matched.

Reports are kept in the `reports` folder and listed under **Saved reports**.

16. Stats: flight stats and the greenie board

The **Stats** page adds up every mission run in the DCS server's own logs on this PC (the live dcs.log, dcs.log.old and the dated .zip copies DCS keeps), plus any server logs you upload there: each pilot's sorties, flight hours, landings, traps, kills, losses, crashes, ejections and hit rate, and the greenie board of every carrier pass the DCS LSO graded. Pick this month, last month, the last 30 days, this year, all time or your own dates, then **Export PDF**, or the **Pilots CSV** and **Greenie board CSV** for a spreadsheet.

Greenie board points: _OK_ 5, OK 4, (OK) 3, bolter 2.5, --- 2, wave-off 1, cut 0. A wave-off for a foul deck is not the pilot's and is not scored. The page also shows your servers' **ElevenLabs credits**.

17. A frequency card for your pilots

Pilots fly better with the frequencies in front of them. Fill this in from Settings > Frequencies and Roles, and put it on your kneeboard or preset card:

Station	Frequency	Preset	Address as
Home field tower			"<Field> Tower"

Home field ATIS		(listen only)
Command	282.000	"Command"
AWACS	264.000	"Darkstar" (your callsign)
Deckboss	128.600	"Deckboss"
Marshal	306.300	"Marshal"
Paddles	128.300	"Paddles"
Tanker / JTAC		"Texaco 1-1" / "Hitman"

All AM except JTACs below 88 MHz (FM). SRS encryption must be off on these frequencies.

18. When something is wrong

What you see	Likely cause	What to do
No answer at all	Controller not running, wrong frequency or modulation, or the call didn't start with the station's name.	Check its card is green; check the frequency and AM/FM; open **Logs** to see whether it heard you and what it heard.
It answered someone else, or the wrong thing	The words were misheard.	Logs shows the words heard. Key, pause, then speak; station first, callsign with its number; a little slower. Check SRS isn't clipping your microphone.
"Say again your callsign"	No callsign with a number was heard.	Repeat with the full callsign.
Silence on every station	SRS password, OpenAI key, or voice output.	Send the **test call** in Setup: it reports exactly what is missing. Check the OpenAI key's **Test** in Settings.
"I don't see you on scope", no picture, no bearings	Tacview isn't reaching Readback.	Turn on Tacview's real-time telemetry on the server and check its address in Settings > Server connection. The header shows Tacview's status.
AWACS off station	No AWACS aircraft airborne in the mission, or it just restarted.	Give it a minute; check the mission has its AWACS flying.
Wrong weather or runway	Controllers are reading a different mission.	Restart the theatre after loading the mission, or use **Read from .miz** in Set Weather.
A changed frequency or voice didn't take	The role hasn't restarted.	Settings > Roles > Restart this theatre's roles.

Voices sound plain (no radio effect)	ffmpeg isn't installed.	Run the installer again and let it install ffmpeg (see the Installation Guide).
A report has no shots or kills	The dcs.log is a client's, not the server's.	Use the server's `Saved Games\DCS.dcs_serverrelease\Logs\dcs.log`.

See the Installation Guide for installing, the trial, licences and updates.

> **Report a problem:** still stuck? Open **Help** → **Report a problem** (or the link under Updates in Settings). Say what happened, roughly when, and on which station, then press **Send to the Readback team**. Readback makes one zip with your description, its versions, settings and the end of each log, with every key and password removed, and posts it in **#bug-reports** on our Discord. Or press **Save the zip instead** and post the message it gives you there with the zip attached.

19. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Angels	Altitude in thousands of feet: angels 12 = 12,000 ft.
BRAA	Bearing, range, altitude, aspect of a contact from you.
BRC	Base recovery course: the carrier's heading for recovery.
Bullseye	A named reference point; positions are given as bearing and range from it.
Charlie	Marshal's signal to leave the stack and land.
Clara	"I don't see the ball" (the carrier's landing light).
DME	Distance in nautical miles from the field or ship.
Fence in / out	Entering / leaving the combat area, switches set.
Joker / Bingo	Fuel to start heading home soon / fuel to go home now.
Marking moms	Your bearing and range from the carrier ("mother").
Picture	The AWACS's summary of the air: groups, positions, tracks.
State	Fuel in thousands of pounds: state 6.5 = 6,500 lb.
Winchester	Out of weapons.

Readback ATC is not affiliated with or endorsed by Eagle Dynamics. DCS World is a trademark of Eagle Dynamics SA.